

in nabbing the real murderers. They made a fatal judgement but it is Aarushi's family which ultimately paid for it.

INDU SHANKAR, *Varanasi*

We The Payers

It pays to be a legislator in this country. The government spends crores in doling out sops to the MLAs and MPs whether it is in the form of houses, luxury cars or laptops ("Playing a Sop Opera", July 28) and it is the common men who end up paying for it. This will reap rich rewards for the likes of Haryana Chief Minister Bhupinder Singh Hooda, who has approved allotment of plots and flats for MPs and MLAs, to keep his political flock from straying.

SUBHASH CHANDRA AGRAWAL,
on e-mail

Look Before You leap

The shareholders need to be cautious about buy-backs ("Buy Bucks", July 28). Some manipulations are made in the stock market to hoodwink the general public into buying, on the spur of rising prices of particular shares.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
on e-mail

Peace Process

As India is a key player in the reconstruction of post-conflict Afghanistan, the dastardly suicide attack on our embassy in Kabul is not only a gross anti-India move but a distinctly anti-Afghan act as well ("Return of Mistrust", July 28). Even Afghan President Hamid Karzai has unequivocally endorsed India's allegation that ISI was behind the attacks. Pakistan's devious

plans, which it is executing with the support of the Taliban and the Al Qaeda, cannot be ignored.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

No Blame Game

It had been mentioned in the story ("A Deadly Ambush", July 14) that the Orissa Police had booked the motor launch four days ahead of the journey of the Greyhound party which is not true. The motor launch was

booked with the irrigation department only the previous day of the proposed journey. The decision to go via Chitradurga reservoir was taken by the Andhra Pradesh Police one week ago. The said decision was communicated to the Orissa Police at the eleventh hour and as such there is no mistake on our part that led to this tragic incidence.

SATISH GAJBHIYE,
Superintendent of Police,
Malkangiri, Orissa

FROM BHIWANI TO BEIJING



VIKRAM SHARMA

Bhiwani, the backwater of Haryana, has lived up to its reputation of producing four out of five boxers in the Olympics team ("The Boys From Bhiwani", July 14). Kudos to their coach, former national boxer Jagdish Singh, who has turned this nondescript town into an elite boxing centre and given hopes to many that this nation of over a billion can win a medal in the Beijing Olympics.

AMRITA ANJUM, *Hyderabad*

Kudos to the indomitable spirit of former coach Jagdish Singh, who, using his talent and innovative training methods, has produced a formidable team of boxing medal hopefuls for the soon-to-begin Beijing Olympics.

SANJAY SHARMA, *Delhi*

Jagdish Singh's boxing factory, which has produced some of the best boxers in the country, has indeed turned Bhiwani into Cuba of India.

AVINASH KUMAR, *Bangalore*

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Years Ago in India Today

SEPTEMBER 1-15, 1978



The S-Bomb

The high drama over the alleged abduction of Defence Minister Jagjivan Ram's son and his college girlfriend which rocked the nation last week had all the makings of a political intrigue, criminal frame-up and caste warfare. It had shades of Watergate and tinges of an exciting paperback thriller. The bizarre incident smelted of political blackmail because it involved Ram's son, Suresh Kumar, a slim seductive college girl called Sushma Rani and a for-



mer aide of Ram's arch-political foe, Charan Singh. The dazed and bruised Kumar walked into the Kashmiri Gate police station on August 21 and said he had been kidnapped the night before by a dozen hefty men. His woman companion, who was also seized with him from his Mercedes car, were driven across the border in Uttar Pradesh and forced to sign documents and pose for photographs in compromising positions. —Arul B. Louis